

Welcome to **Music City Data User Group**

Nashville's SQL Server & Microsoft Data Platform Community

Wednesday, July 22, 2026 · Tonight's Speaker: Louis Davidson



Tonight's Agenda

- **5:30 - 6:00 Networking, Food & Drinks**
Grab a seat, meet fellow data pros
- **6:00 - 6:15 Welcome & Announcements**
Community updates
- **6:15 - 7:15 Presentation**
Relational Database Design: Work With SQL Server, Not Against It
- **7:15 - 7:30 Questions & Networking**
Wrap up conversations before you head out

Thank You to Our
Host & Sponsor

Vaco by Highspring

5501 Virginia Way, Suite 120 · Brentwood, TN

Thank you for the space, refreshments, and community support!

What is MC-DUG?

Music City Data Users Group

Nashville's community for data professionals focused on SQL Server & the Microsoft Data Platform.

Who it's for: DBAs · Developers · Data Engineers · Analysts · Architects · Anyone learning data

Topics: SQL Server & Azure SQL · T-SQL & Performance · PowerShell & Automation · Data Engineering & Warehousing · Career Growth

Come for the data. Stay for the community.

Meet the Organizers

Jason Romans — Lead Organizer

Microsoft MVP based in Nashville, focused on Microsoft Fabric, Power BI & data modeling.

Recognized as: Sessionize Most Active Speaker, 3 years running

Kevin Kline — Co-Organizer

Microsoft Data Platform MVP for 20+ years; Founder & former President of PASS.

Also known for: Co-author, SQL in a Nutshell (O'Reilly)

Two organizers. One growing Nashville data community.

Code of Conduct

We're all here to learn and grow together.

Please keep things:

- **Respectful** — treat everyone with courtesy
- **Professional** — keep discussions constructive
- **Inclusive** — everyone belongs here
- **No spam or solicitation**

Full Code of Conduct:

conduct.musiccitydata.org

Stay Connected

- ▶ **Meetup** — The main place for upcoming meetings & activities
Check Meetup for the next session, RSVPs, and announcements
- ▶ **Email** — Reach the organizers anytime
organizers@musiccitydata.org
- ▶ **GitHub** —
Mainly for slides: **slides.musiccitydata.org**
Code of Conduct: **conduct.musiccitydata.org**

Other Microsoft Communities in Nashville

Coming up at other Nashville groups:

- ▶ **Nashville Power BI User Group**

*“From Tableau to Power BI: A Real World Transition Guide” —
TBD · 5:00 PM*

meetup.com/nashville-modern-excel-user-group

- ▶ **Nashville .NET User Group**

Monthly Meeting — Thu, Aug 13 · 5:30 PM

meetup.com/nashdotnet

- ▶ **Nashville Microsoft Azure Users Group**

Monthly Meeting — Wed, Aug 12 · 5:30 PM

meetup.com/the-nashville-microsoft-azure-users-group

- ▶ **Microsoft 365 Users Group of Nashville & Knoxville**

meetup.com/m365usergroup

New Speakers Welcome!



Interested in presenting but haven't done it before?
We'd love to help you get started. Here are some easy ways to ease in:

- ▶ **Lightning Talks** — 5–10 minutes on a tip, tool, or lesson learned
- ▶ **Short Session Before the Main Talk** — A 15–20 min opener to warm up the room
- ▶ **Full Presentation** — When you're ready for the full stage

No experience needed — just a willingness to share!

New Certification Alert: DP-800

Microsoft just launched a new certification for SQL pros diving into AI:

- ▶ **SQL AI Developer Associate** — Microsoft's newest cert, GA since May 2026
- ▶ **What it covers** — T-SQL AI functions, vector embeddings, semantic search & RAG
- ▶ **Where it applies** — SQL Server, Azure SQL & Fabric SQL databases
- ▶ **Free cert offer** — Join [Fabric Data Days 2026](#) for a free cert
A great next step after T-SQL.

Where to Find Us

- ▶ **Our Home**

musiccitydata.org (redirects to Meetup)

- ▶ **Join on Meetup**

meetup.com/music-city-data-user-group

- ▶ **Want to Speak?**

Session submissions coming soon

- ▶ **Contact**

organizers@musiccitydata.org

Upcoming Events

Mark your calendars for these free community data conferences:

Nashville Microsoft Community Day

Friday, September 11 · Nelson Andrews Leadership Center

Day of Data Albany

Saturday, August 8 · Massry School of Business, UAlbany

Next Meeting

Tuesday, August 4, 2026

Brian Dill · DuckDB (title TBD)

Vaco · Brentwood, TN

**RSVP at musiccitydata.org once
listed**

Our Meeting Cadence

We're settling into a monthly rhythm — 1st Tuesday of the month at Vaco:

- ▶ **Aug 4**
- ▶ **Sep 3**
- ▶ **Oct 7**
- ▶ **Nov 3**
- ▶ **Dec 1**

Get the Slides



slides.musiccitydata.org



Hosted on **GitHub**

Presentation decks may be available if not hosted by speaker

All slides are open and freely available

About Louis Davidson

- ▶ Also known as DrSQL — database design fanatic with 25+ years of experience
- ▶ Longtime blogger, author, editor & speaker on relational database design

NOW

Louis Davidson

Relational Database Design: Work With SQL Server, Not Against It

*SELECT * FROM community*